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Global Gas & LNG | North America

After the Rally, What's Next?

Low inventories, seasonally stronger demand, and the ongoing loss of supply has pushed JKM toward our forecast, with prices now up >2x YTD. VG & Cheniere have bounced off the late-June lows, but still trade below our estimate of base asset value. We review latest market trends & preview 2Q results.

Key Takeaways

- JKM prices +35% since the start of July, now up >2x YTD. With low storage & 20% of supply still offline, we would be buyers of any de-escalation pullbacks.
- Cheniere: 2Q EBITDA of ~\$1.7 B sits near consensus while our full-year estimate of \$7.8 B is just above the FY26 guide of \$7.25-7.75 B.
- EE: In-line 2Q EBITDA of \$119 MM with full-year estimate roughly aligned with the midpoint of guidance (MS: \$494 MM, guide: \$480-510).
- NEXT: Phase 1 tracks of schedule and management hones in on growth with Train 6's FERC permit filed in May. Focus is on continuing to de-risk future projects.
- VG: 2Q EBITDA of \$2.5 B, in-line with cons. MSe 2026 of \$8.5 B is just above cons of \$8.4 B and at the high end of the FY26 range.

JKM (Asia LNG) & TTF (European Gas) move higher. Over the last few months, we have argued that global LNG prices were too low, with risks skewed to the upside in 2H26 from low global inventories, seasonally recovering demand, ongoing loss of supply, and lingering geopolitical risks. As the Iran conflict re-escalated in early July, further delaying any resumption in Qatari exports, JKM and TTF prices have rallied sharply - up >35% since the start of the month and now ~2x higher than pre-conflict. Asia demand has recovered alongside supportive summer weather, +1% y/y over the past month, pulling cargos away from an EU market that desperately needs them. Over the last 30 days, European imports were -24% lower y/y, leaving storage only 54% full vs 64% this time last year. Even with a near-term restart of Qatari exports, normalizing storage ahead of winter appears increasingly unlikely. As a result, upside risks persist and we would be buyers of any de-escalation pullbacks in both the commodity and exposed stocks.

What's priced in? In late June we explored upside across the US LNG Exporters (see [Exploring Upside](#)). Share prices had broken far below our estimate of base asset value (assets that are operational, under construction, or locked in). While the stocks have recovered over the last few weeks, both VG and Cheniere still trade intrinsically cheap, on our estimates. We value VG's base portfolio (including under construction projects) at \$17/sh (+21% above the current share price) and \$272/sh for Cheniere (+4%). Execution on further growth, which we view as likely for both, represents upside to these figures. Conversely, NEXT is relatively in-line with our valuation.

MORGAN STANLEY & CO. LLC

Devin McDermott

Equity Analyst and Commodities Strategist

Devin.McDermott@morganstanley.com

+1 212 761-1125

Joe Laetsch, CFA

Equity Analyst

Joe.Laetsch@morganstanley.com

+1 212 761-8804

Jacqueline M Kenny

Research Associate

Jacqueline.Kenny@morganstanley.com

+1 212 761-2253

Helen Lin

Research Associate

Helen.Lin@morganstanley.com

+1 212 761-0766

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Industry View

In-Line

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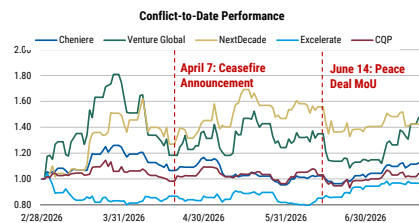
For analyst certification and other important disclosures, refer to the Disclosure Section, located at the end of this report.

Previewing 2Q results for US LNG companies. With this note, we refresh our forecasts for latest company updates. Our 2026 EBITDA estimates are largely in-line with consensus. See below for our views into earnings:

- **Cheniere.** We forecast \$1.7 B of 2Q EBITDA (cons: \$1.7 B), representing a relatively clean quarter with no major operational disruptions or notable downtime. Our full-year estimate of \$7.8 B is unchanged vs prior (cons: \$7.8 B, guide: \$7.25 - 7.75), although would be closer to \$8.0 B if TTF/JKM futures as of 7/21 hold. Cheniere achieved substantial completion at CCL Stage 3 Train 6 in June and Train 7 is tracking towards fall completion. On July, 17th, Cheniere received permission from FERC to introduce fuel gas to the train. We continue to model full year sales volumes of ~53 mt. With Sabine Pass Train 7 now commercialized and limited notice to proceed (LNTP) issued, we look forward to receiving updates on permitting before final investment decision (FID, MSe YE26). Cheniere PT is unchanged at \$308, remain Overweight. CQP PT moves to \$62/sh (\$72 prior) as we shift some of our assumed future growth away from Sabine Pass to the Corpus Christi site, remain Equal-weight.
- **EE.** We model \$119 MM of 2Q EBITDA (cons: \$118 MM) with full-year EBITDA of \$494 MM, slightly above consensus of \$491 MM and just below the midpoint of guidance (\$480 - 510 MM). We assume that EE did not receive its contracted volume under its Qatar LNG contract during 2Q, a ~\$3 MM EBITDA impact. We also now assume that this volume disruption persists through 3Q, but our full-year EBITDA estimate remains near the midpoint of guidance. We continue to model a mid-2027 start for the Iraq terminal. We look forward to receiving updates on fleet optimization, macro environment, growth project progress, and QatarEnergy deliveries on the call. PT of \$40/sh unchanged, stay Equal-weight.
- **NEXT.** Rio Grande Phase 1 continues to track ahead of schedule and NEXT is messaging first LNG in 1H27, although directionality within those months is limited. While NEXT has been quietly preparing for commissioning on Train 1, the company has seconded ~100 people on the operations team to Bechtel to train employees and expedite commissioning. Looking towards longer-dated growth, NEXT filed its full application for Train 6 in late May -- an acceleration vs prior expectations. While we wait formal guidance on permit timing, NEXT expects to concurrently progress contracting and EPC negotiations. Stay Equal-weight with \$8/sh PT.
- **VG.** We model \$2.47 B of 2Q EBITDA (cons \$2.52 B) with 37 cargoes from Calcasieu Pass and 90 from Plaquemines, anchored by fixed liquefaction fees of \$6.45/mmbtu for the quarter (disclosed earlier this month). Earlier this summer, VG signed agreements with EnBW for a new LNG SPA and announced an upsize of its existing agreement with Atlantic-SEE. VG's 2026 guidance provided alongside 1Q earnings implies a liquefaction fee range of \$9.50 - 10.50/mmbtu. We estimate actuals in 2Q were near the midpoint of this range, but bal-year pricing currently sits closer to \$15 – potentially supporting upside to VG's EBITDA outlook alongside 2Q results. Our EBITDA of \$8.5 B sits just above cons of \$8.4 B and at the high end of its \$8.3 - 8.5 B range. If current JKM/TTF prices hold, estimate would be closer to \$9.0 B.

Remain Overweight, \$22/sh PT.

Exhibit 1: After a dip in June following MoU news, share prices have begun to recover for LNG stocks in our coverage.



Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 2: JKM prices have rallied, in-line with our constructive view. Our 2026 forecasts remain modestly above the forward curve, more in-line on 2027-28.

Asia LNG (JKM)			
	MSe	Forward Curve	% Upside/Downside
3Q26e	\$22.50	\$21.64	4%
4Q26e	\$25.00	\$20.75	20%
Bal-2026e	\$23.75	\$20.97	13%
2027e	\$15.00	\$14.85	1%
2028e	\$10.00	\$10.58	-5%
Long Term	\$10.00	N/A	N/A

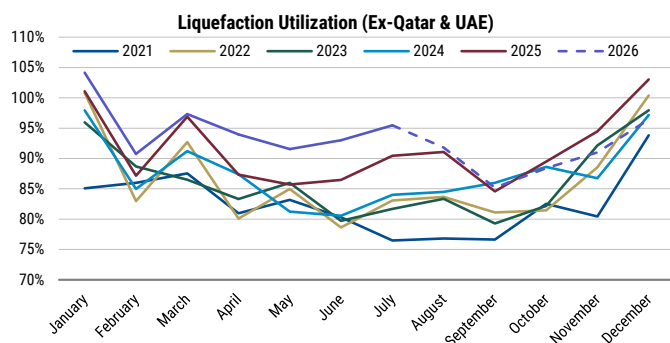
Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research

LNG Supply & Demand Trends

Supply. CEO Saad Al-Kaabi said on July 9th that QatarEnergy had decided to halt plans to resume output after an attack on one of its tankers put the safety of strait transit in question. Back in June, QatarEnergy noted that it expects to be able to raise output to 50% of capacity a month after safe passage is restored and 80% within 2 months (all capacity excluding damaged trains). This week, Yemen's Houthis declared a naval blockade on Saudi Arabia, presenting risk to transit through Bab-el-Mandeb – a lesser impact for LNG but a move that could introduce greater geopolitical uncertainty as ~4.5 bbl/d of crude, condensate, and petroleum products transit through the waterway (see more [here](#)).

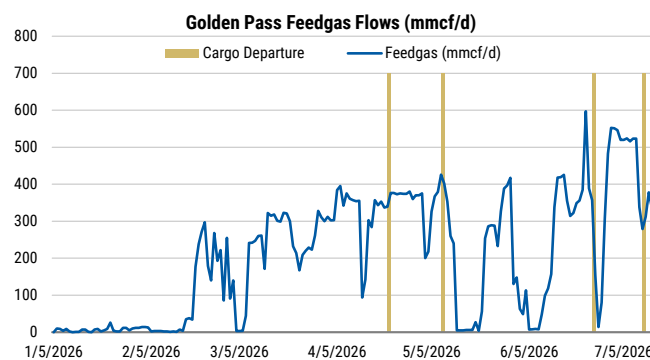
Outside of the Middle East, LNG supply disruptions have been somewhat minimal. Golden Pass (18 mtpa once fully ramped) continues commissioning, but recent feedgas flows indicate a spotty startup. So far, the facility has exported 4 cargoes (one currently en route to Korea, diverted away from the Netherlands and later Brazil). Freeport LNG (16.5 mtpa total) began planned maintenance on July 10th and feedgas flows fell accordingly. Latest messaging is that the turnaround is expected to last until late August. After Corpus Christi Stage 3 Train 6 achieved substantial completion in June, Train 7 appears on track for the fall, if not sooner.

Exhibit 3: Ex the Middle East, global liquefaction utilization in July so far has sat at 95%, above the 83% 5-year avg and 90% seen last year. August utilization is expected to sit at 92%, above last year's 91% and the 5-year avg of 84%.



Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research

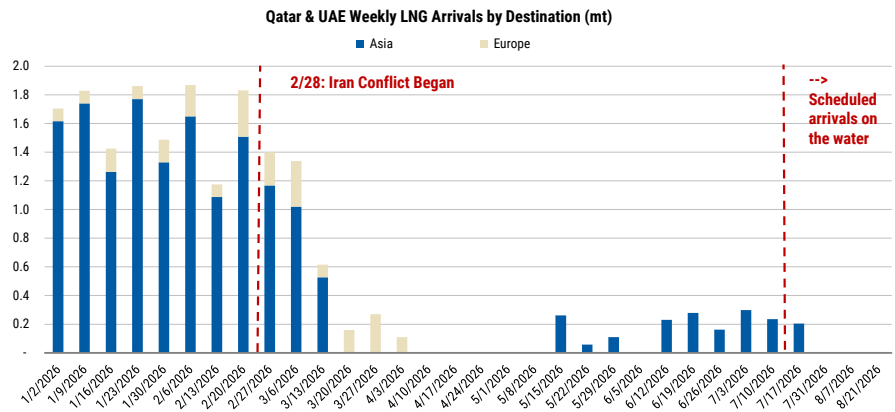
Exhibit 4: Feedgas flows at Golden Pass remain volatile as the facility continues commissioning.



Source: Platts, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 5:

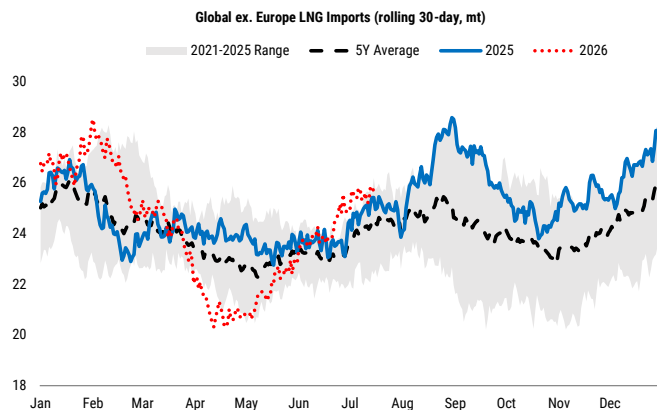
With the strait's status in flux, near-term deliveries on the water are limited. Beyond the 0.2 mtpa nearing final destinations, 0.5 mtpa is loaded and waiting behind the strait.



Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Scheduled arrivals exclude vessels behind Strait of Hormuz, data as of 7.17.26

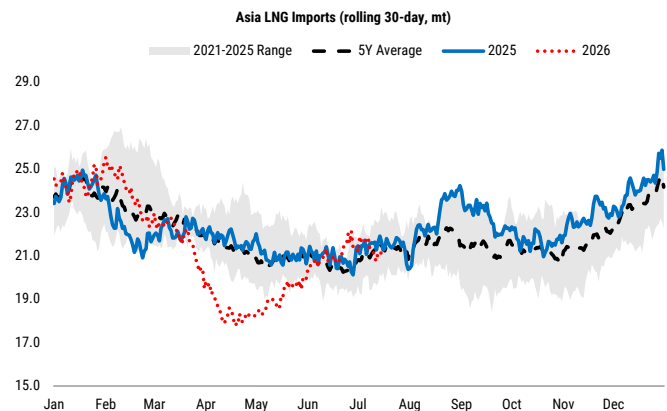
Demand. Global imports ex-Europe are 3% higher over the last 30 days y/y, driven in part by India (+12%) and Taiwan (+10%). Growth over the last 2 weeks has accelerated globally (ex-EU) as Japan (+25% y/y over last 2 weeks) has worked to refill inventories and Taiwan is 23% higher over that same time period. Since diversifying its sources of LNG, the US is Taiwan's largest supplier. July is shaping up to be warmer than normal with CDDs (cooling degree days) 5% above the 10-year normal while August is more in-line with normal levels. In Europe, July is expected to be the second hottest since 2000 with CDDs 26% above the 10-year normal. With European inventory levels below normal levels and imports lower than last year's, we expect LNG demand in the continent to accelerate over the coming quarters – driving LNG prices higher as a result.

Exhibit 6: Over the last 30 days, global imports ex-Europe are 3% higher y/y and are now flat y/y YTD.



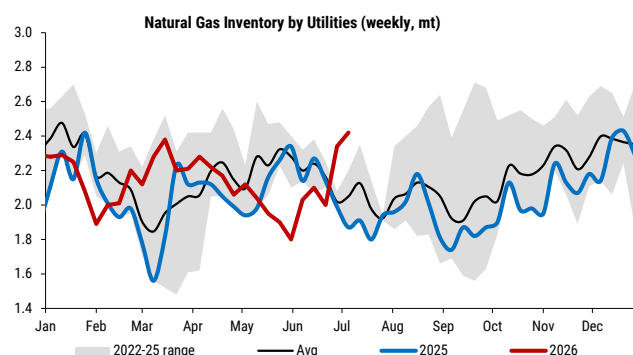
Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 7: Asia's LNG imports now sit 3% lower y/y YTD and are +1% over the last 30 days y/y– supported by 6% growth over the last 2 weeks compared to the same time last year.



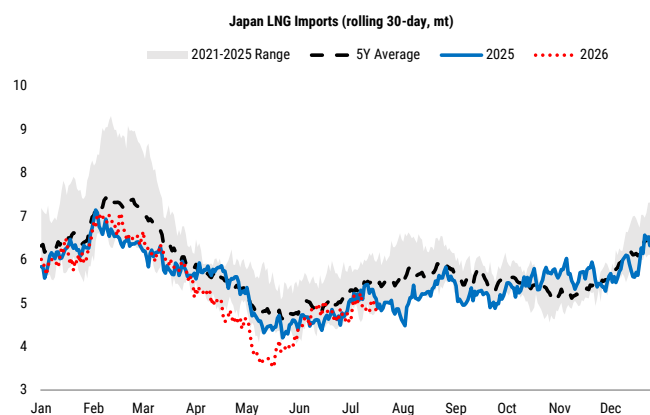
Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 8: After dipping earlier in the summer, Japan's natural gas inventories have moved sharply higher...



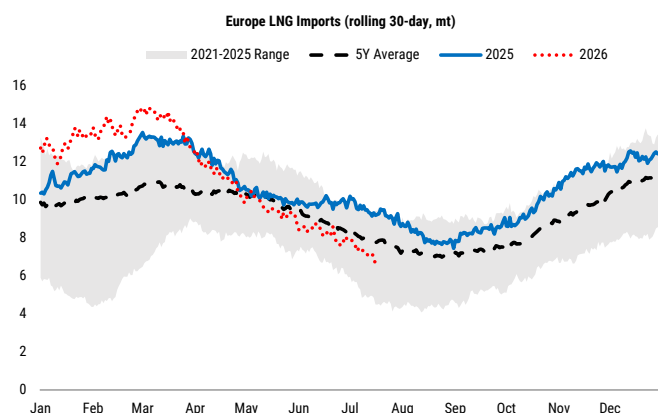
Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research.

Exhibit 9: ... Supported by an increase in LNG imports. While YTD imports are 3% lower y/y and the 30-day figure is -4%, imports have recovered over the last 2 weeks and were 25% higher y/y.



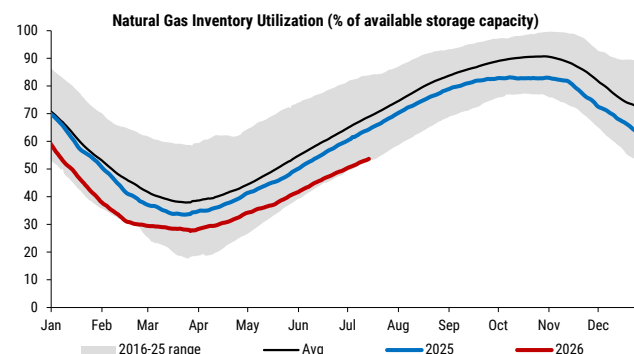
Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research.

Exhibit 10: In contrast, Europe's LNG imports sit 2% lower y/y YTD and -24% lower over the last 30 days y/y...



Source: Vortexa, Morgan Stanley Research.

Exhibit 11: ... and European gas inventories are now 54% full, below last year's 64% fill at this time and the 2016-25 average of 69%.



Source: Bloomberg, Morgan Stanley Research.

Exhibit 12:

We see the market in a shortfall this year, moving closer to balance in 2027-28 before swinging to a greater surplus later in the decade.

Global Supply Demand (mtpa)	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Global Demand	351	370	396	399	404	423	426	466	508	547	576
Sequential Growth	2%	5%	7%	1%	1%	5%	1%	9%	9%	8%	5%
Global Effective Capacity	412	407	417	436	440	446	448	510	560	607	656
Sequential Growth	7%	-1%	2%	5%	1%	1%	0%	14%	10%	8%	8%
Global Supply - Adjusted for Downtime	370	354	369	404	404	424	412	469	515	559	604
Utilization Rate	90%	87%	89%	93%	92%	95%	92%	92%	92%	92%	92%
Surplus/(shortage)	19	(16)	(27)	5	(0)	1	(13)	3	7	12	27
% surplus/(shortage)	5%	-4%	-7%	1%	0%	0%	-3%	1%	1%	2%	5%
Global Supply (ex-potential FIDs)	412	407	417	436	440	446	448	510	560	607	653
MSe Supply From Unsolicited Projects	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3
Surplus/(shortage) at 92% utilization (Excluding potential FIDs)	19	(16)	(27)	5	(0)	1	(13)	3	7	12	24

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Venture Global (VG), Overweight, PT \$22

Remain Overweight, PT of \$22/sh. Venture Global's "design one, build many" approach for mid-scale factory-made trains provides attractive speed to market and outperformance vs. nameplate, a strength relative to peers. Further, VG's contracting strategy offers the most upside exposure to elevated global LNG prices, with ~15% of 2026 cargo sales open to the market as of the start of May and an average of 35% 2026-29 on VG's latest disclosure. For 2026, each \$1 change in margins on this unsold capacity impacts this year's EBITDA by \$300 - 350 MM as of the 1Q call in early May, making VG the most exposed name in our coverage to elevated global LNG prices. Guidance assumes an open liquefaction fee range of \$9.50-10.50/mmbtu for unsold cargoes.

Bolt-ons provide upside. Beyond existing and under-construction growth, Venture Global has messaged bolt-on expansions of ~10 mtpa at CP2 and ~6.4 mtpa at Plaquemines, both inclusive of optimization upside. VG expects to reach positive FID on the CP2 expansion in early 2027 with a short 18-month timeline to first LNG with a broader 2027 goal for the Plaquemines expansion. Regulatory pre-filing requirements were waived by FERC for CP2, while the Plaquemines bolt-on filed for approval with FERC and DOE in late 2025.

Exhibit 13: Venture Global's bolt-on strategy

CP2 Expansion

- > Addition of 12 mid-scale liquefaction trains at CP2
- > Within the existing CP2 footprint
- > Expected capacity of 10 MTPA
- > Target FID early 2027
- > Target first production late 2028
- > Regulatory pre-filing waived by FERC



Plaquemines Bolt-on Phase I

- > Addition of 8 mid-scale liquefaction trains at Plaquemines
- > Includes the first phase of the Cloud Connector pipeline
- > Expected capacity of 6.4 MTPA in Phase I, with potential for additional phases
- > Target FID 2027
- > Target first production 2029
- > Filed for approval with FERC and DOE in late 2025



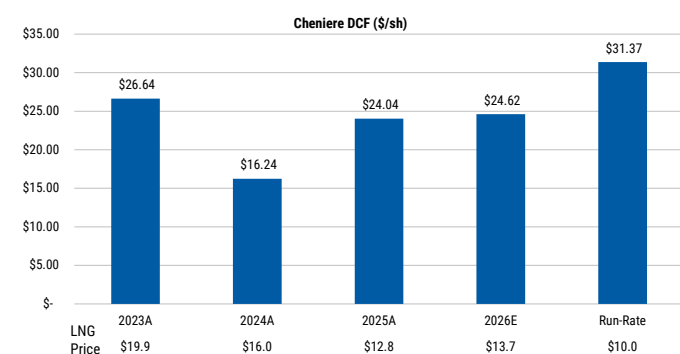
Source: Company presentation

Cheniere Energy (LNG), Overweight, PT \$308

Maintain Overweight, PT of \$308/sh. Cheniere remains a dominant LNG player in the US and is structurally advantaged compared to smaller independent US peers given its existing platform, with stable cash flow backed by long-term contracts. Almost 95% of the company's liquefaction capacity is sold under fixed-price sales agreements through 2030, supporting stable cash flow regardless of where LNG prices go. More importantly, the improved macro backdrop increases the likelihood of additional growth projects reaching a positive FID over the next 1-2 years. Including Trains 8 & 9 (already under construction) and planned growth at both CCL and SPL (MSe assumes 1 more train at each site), we forecast run-rate DCF of ~\$31/sh – implying a 12% yield on the current stock price. As CCL Stage 3 continues to ramp on-schedule with FERC approval for feedgas recently received (substantial completion on its final train expected this fall), focus shifts towards execution on commissioning and execution on future growth.

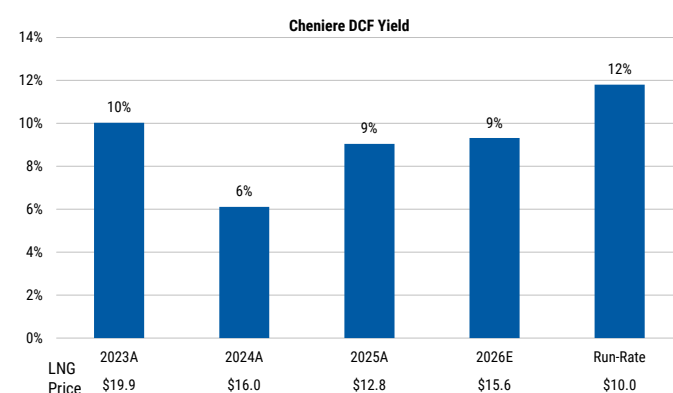
Growth inches closer. Cheniere expects Phase 1 of the planned expansions at CCL and SPL to increase total production to ~71-75 mtpa with a pathway to >100 mtpa of total production longer-term. In early February, Cheniere filed its FERC application for the CCL Expansion Project in early February (up to 24 mtpa, inclusive of debottlenecking) and will look to FID one train in 2027 with no new tanks, berths, or pipelines required. At SPL, Cheniere expects a FERC permit in late 2026 to enable a 2027 FID for Train 7 – the first of three trains in the two-phase project (peak production of ~20 mtpa). Cheniere issued limited notice to proceed (LNT) to Bechtel in late May with all-in costs of \$780/tonne.

Exhibit 14: We forecast Cheniere's distributable cash flow at a run-rate of \$31/sh...



Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: LNG price is based on the MSe Asian LNG price (JKM).

Exhibit 15: ... Supporting a yield of 12% on the current share price.



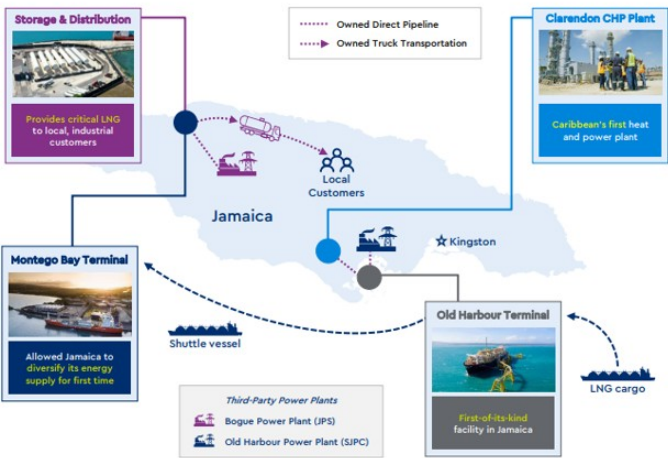
Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: LNG price is based on the MSe Asian LNG price (JKM).

Excelerate Energy (EE), Equal-weight, PT \$40

Jamaica asset provides downstream platform. At the end of March 2025, EE announced its purchase of New Fortress Energy's Jamaica assets, providing ~30 Tbtu of contracted demand. The gas sales and LNG supply are both indexed to Henry Hub, mitigating any commodity price risk. With the acquisition, management discussed potential for these assets to provide a platform for further growth in the country, including optimization of existing operations and underutilized plants, expanding the CHP plant, supporting island- and region-wide fuel switching, and LNG bunkering longer-term to serve opportunities in the Atlantic Basin more broadly. More near term, EE has identified opportunity for the conversion of Jamalco units from heavy diesel to natural gas, although commercial terms need to be finalized. We look forward to hearing details on how EE will execute on its "hub and spoke" concept in the region.

Macro uncertainty, but cash flows largely intact. Since EE's announcement of a fully integrated LNG import terminal in Iraq, the ongoing conflict in the Middle East has presented start-up uncertainty. Management has disclosed that it expects to be able to bring Iraq online ~6 months after it is safe to transit through the Strait of Hormuz with the new-build FSRU *Acadia* being used to service Jordan's National Electric Power Company's existing LNG terminal in Aqaba for 9 months. Latest satellite data from Vortexa indicates that the vessel is now in Aqaba, suggesting that deliveries under the agreement have commenced – in alignment with guidance. As deliveries under EE's QatarEnergy/Petrobangla gas sales contract have halted due to the ongoing Strait closure, we model \$1 MM of lost EBITDA for each month that gas sales do not occur and continue to expect EE's 2026 EBITDA to sit near the midpoint of the current full-year guide.

Exhibit 16: In late March of 2025, EE announced its acquisition of NFE's Jamaica assets, raising EBITDA by ~\$110 MM/yr.



Source: Company Presentation, April 2025

Exhibit 17: EE's Iraq terminal (announced in October 2025) is expected to add between \$105 - 110 MM of annual EBITDA (5x multiple on \$520 - 550 MM capex).



Source: Morgan Stanley Research.

NextDecade (NEXT), Equal-weight, PT \$8

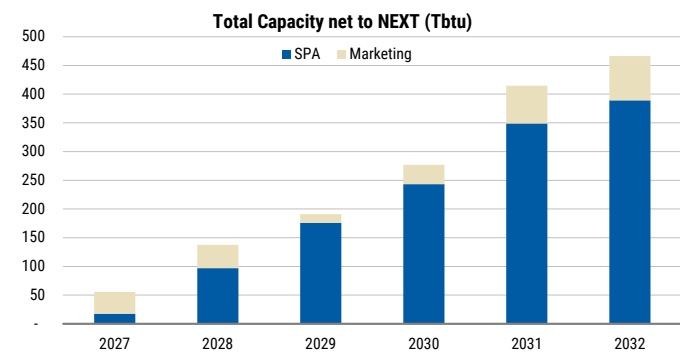
Remain Equal-weight, PT of \$8/sh. Rio Grande Phase 1 (17.61 mtpa) is under construction with NEXT expecting a 1H27 startup and first gas later this year. This is consistent with Bechtel's track record on other similar projects and we look forward to receiving further updates here, especially as the company could look to sign contracts for commissioning volumes later this year or into early 2027.

Train 4 details. Train 4 is expected to produce ~5.9 mtpa of LNG (total Rio Grande capacity under construction now at ~24 mtpa) upon guaranteed substantial completion in the back half of 2030. About 77% of the volumes is sold under 20-year SPAs indexed to Henry Hub plus a fixed fee. NEXT estimates total project cost at \$6.7 B with spending financed roughly 60%/40% debt/equity at the project level. While the company currently holds a 40% interest in the project, this will increase to 60% after equity partners receive a certain return on investment (management expects mid-2030s at a \$5 open cargo margin).

Train 5 details. Similar to Train 4, Train 5 will produce ~5.9 mtpa of LNG and is fully commercialized, with ~75% of the volume contracted under 20-year Henry Hub indexed SPAs. The project cost is roughly \$6.7 B and will be financed at 60%/40% debt/equity at the project level. NEXT owns a 50% interest in this train, growing to 70% after equity partners reach their return target. The fifth train has guaranteed substantial completion in 1H31 and is expected to flip to 70% ownership in the mid-2030s, consistent with Train 4.

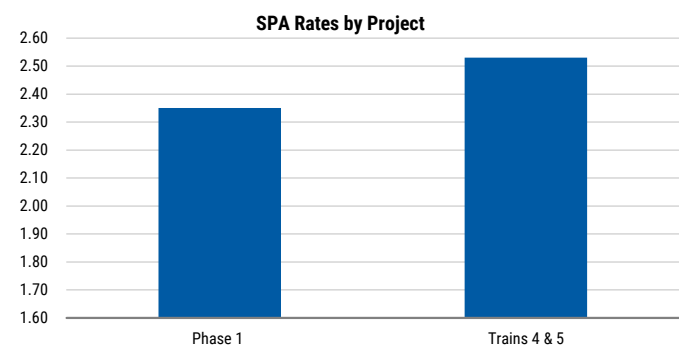
Growth beyond Train 5. NEXT continues to message aspirations for projects beyond Phase 1 and Trains 4 & 5. Management filed Train 6's FERC application in late May after requesting they waive the last month of the required 6-month gap between pre-filing and official filing (permits in hand expected as early as 2027). While no contracts have been announced yet, our understanding is that conversations are ongoing with potential offtakers and EPC discussions are progressing. While Train 6 is adjacent to Train 5 and would be able to utilize shared infrastructure, Trains 7 & 8 are likely to undergo a separate permit process and require an additional levee and infrastructure. Management expects to commercialize Train 6 in conjunction with permitting and aims to begin commercializing the facility, but no offtake contracts have been announced yet.

Exhibit 18: Prior to 4Q25 earnings, NEXT sold forward a portion of Phase 1 volumes for pre-Train 3 DFCD – reducing open exposure near-term.



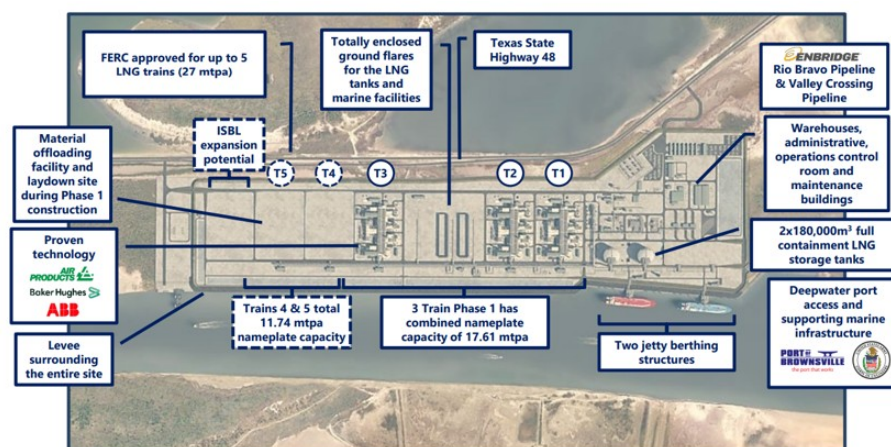
Source: Morgan Stanley Research. .

Exhibit 19: We estimate an SPA rate of \$2.35 on Phase 1 and \$2.53 on Trains 4 & 5.



Source: Morgan Stanley Research.

Rio Grande LNG Project Overview



Source: Company Presentation

Liquefaction Facility: The Rio Grande project is an up to 27 mtpa (5 train) liquefaction facility in Brownsville, Texas, situated within the Port of Brownsville. The company declared positive FID on its 3-train first phase on 7/12/2023, Train 4 on 9/9/2025, and Train 5 on 10/16/2025. The site is located 7 miles away from the Gulf of America with easy deepwater port access with supporting marine infrastructure and services.

Regulatory Status: In August 2024, the DC Circuit Court issued an order vacating FERC's remand authorization of Rio Grande LNG on the grounds that FERC should have issued a supplemental Environmental Impact Statement (SEIS) during its remand process. The DC Circuit Court appeal process is now complete and NEXT received a final draft at the end of July, in-line with expectations. This overhang is now resolved and we do not expect any further conflicts with NEXT's permits.

Technology: Rio Grande is based on the design of Peru LNG. It utilizes the proven APCI C3MRtm liquefaction process, an ABB automation system, and GE rotating equipment for trains.

Pipeline/feed gas: NextDecade intends to procure feed gas from upstream producers in the Eagle Ford, Permian, or Barnett. The company has agreements with Enbridge (covered by Robert Kad) to access two pipelines: Rio Bravo Pipeline (RBPL) and Valley Crossing Pipeline (VCP). Rio Grande will be directly connected to both VCP and RBPL. Enbridge will build, own, and operate the RBPL — NEXT is no longer participating in the planning process after the pipeline company was sold in March 2020. The project's location in South Texas offers access to discounted gas (Agua Dulce Hub) relative to many other LNG facilities in the US (most of which purchase gas at prices near Henry Hub).

EPC Contract: In May 2019, NEXT signed a lump-sum turnkey EPC contract with Bechtel. In August 2022, NEXT updated its EPC cost guidance to \$647/tonne for trains 1-3 for a total contract of ~\$600/tonne across 5-train system. Upon FID in July 2023, NEXT updated its Phase 1 (3 train) EPC costs to a total contract of \$681/tonne. In early August 2024, NEXT executed an EPC with Bechtel for Train 4 totaling \$4.3 B (\$733/tonne) with

total costs of \$6.0-6.3 B including owners' costs and related infrastructure (~\$1,037/tonne). On June 12th, NEXT announced updated EPC costs for Train 4 of \$815/ton (\$6.57-6.77 B total), roughly 10% higher than the initial EPC deal struck in August 2024 which expired earlier this year. On Sept 3rd, Train 5's EPC was updated to \$6.7 B of total costs, an increase from \$6.12-6.32 B prior (inclusive of EPC, owners' costs, contingencies).

Commercial Agreements & Financing: NEXT is ~92% contracted on its 3-train development at Rio Grande with a weighted average contract length of ~19 years and average size of 1.8 mtpa. Train 4 is ~77% contracted with an average contract length of 20 years and Train 5 is ~75% contracted with an average contract length of 20 years. In late January, ADNOC announced it would be acquiring an additional 7.6% stake in Trains 4 & 5 from GIP, adding to its existing 11.7% stake in Phase 1.

Diversified Natural Gas Comps

Exhibit 20: Diversified Natural Gas Comps

Company	Ticker	Rating	Price 7/21/26	Market Cap (\$ MM)	Price Target	PT Upside	EV/EBITDA			Free Cash Flow Yield			Net Debt/EBITDA			Dividend Yield		
							2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Cheniere Energy	LNG	OW	\$264.95	55,033	\$308	16%	12.0x	11.5x	11.1x	6%	6%	3%	2.5x	2.2x	1.9x	0.9%	0.9%	1.0%
Cheniere Energy Partners LP	CQP	EW	\$63.83	30,912	\$62	-3%	11.5x	12.4x	12.5x	9%	8%	8%	3.8x	4.3x	4.5x	5.0%	5.1%	5.1%
Excellerate Energy	EE	EW	\$38.91	1,272	\$40	3%	10.3x	8.5x	6.8x	2%	21%	38%	1.6x	1.0x	0.2x	0.9%	0.9%	1.0%
NextDecade	NEXT	EW	\$7.68	1,970	\$8	4%	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
Venture Global Inc.	VG	OW	\$14.29	35,501	\$22	54%	9.9x	17.2x	15.8x	-14%	-25%	-9%	5.2x	10.0x	9.6x	0.5%	0.5%	0.5%
Average							10.9x	12.4x	11.5x	1%	2%	10%	3.3x	4.4x	4.0x	1%	1%	2%
Median							10.9x	10.0x	8.9x	4%	14%	23%	3.2x	3.2x	2.6x	1%	1%	1%

Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research estimates

Exhibit 21: Updated Comp EPS

Company	Ticker	Rating	EPS								
			MS			Consensus			MS vs Street		
			2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Cheniere Energy	LNG	OW	20.42	18.18	13.12	(4.66)	16.45	15.01	NM	11%	-13%
Cheniere Energy Partners LP	CQP	EW	4.84	4.71	4.74	3.90	4.37	4.33	24%	8%	9%
Excellerate Energy	EE	EW	1.60	2.19	2.77	1.50	1.94	2.71	7%	12%	2%
NextDecade	NEXT	EW	(3.78)	(1.39)	(1.80)	(2.32)	(0.77)	(0.62)	NM	NM	NM
Venture Global Inc.	VG	OW	1.31	0.23	0.19	1.49	0.72	1.24	-12%	-68%	-85%
Average									6%	-9%	-21%
Median									24%	11%	2%

Source: FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward – Cheniere Energy Partners LP (CQP.N)

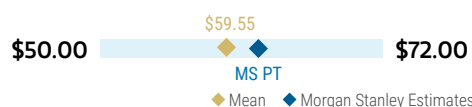
Limited distribution growth potential drives Equal-Weight rating

PRICE TARGET \$62.00

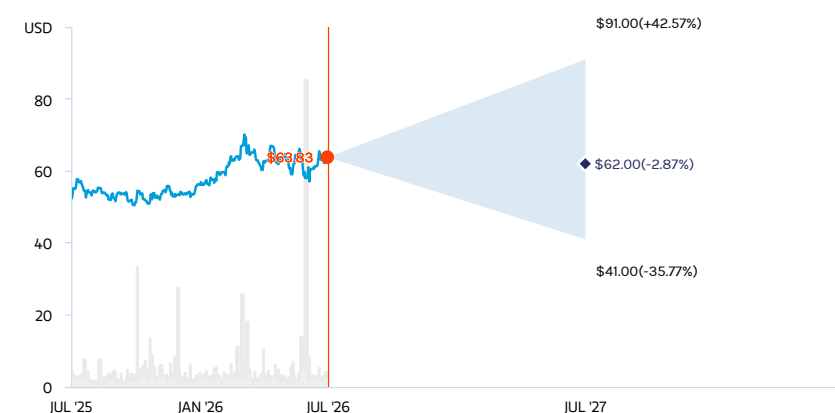
Derived from our base case DDM using a 5.7% WACC.

Consensus Price Target Distribution

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research



RISK REWARD CHART



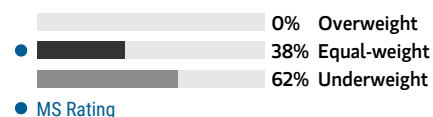
Key: — Historical Stock Performance ● Current Stock Price ◆ Price Target

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

EQUAL-WEIGHT THESIS

- Pure play exposure to liquefied natural gas infrastructure with a first mover advantage through the development of the first U.S. LNG export terminal in the US in Sabine Pass
- Limited downside due to stable stream of cash flows from firm, fixed fee, 20-year take-or-pay for 78% of Sabine Pass Liquefaction's capacity

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Disruption: Positive

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes [here](#)

BULL CASE

\$91.00

Derived from our bull case DDM.

Higher LNG margins benefit distributions. LNG prices average \$12/mmbtu in Asia, with long-term Henry Hub prices of \$3.25, benefitting export margins. SPL Trains 1-6 and the SPL Expansion (in addition to pre-FID growth) support a steady state distribution of ~\$3.30. Assumes 5.6% discount rate and terminal multiple of 10x.

BASE CASE

\$62.00

Derived from our base case DDM.

Future FCF generation supports annual distribution of ~\$3.15-\$4.00. SPL Trains 1-6 support a steady state distribution of ~\$3.15-\$4.00 with SPL expansion raising distribution to >\$5.00 over time. Assumes 5.9% discount rate and terminal multiple of 10x.

BEAR CASE

\$41.00

Derived from our bear case DDM.

Limited distribution growth. Assumes distributions are held flat at \$3.00 annually, discount rate of 6.5%, and terminal multiple of 10x.

Risk Reward – Cheniere Energy Partners LP (CQP.N)

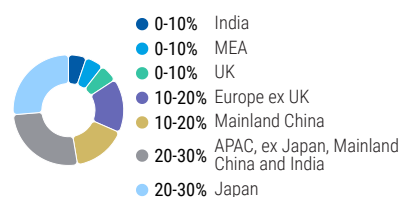
KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	Dec 2025	Dec 2026e	Dec 2027e	Dec 2028e
Sabine Pass liquefaction capacity (TBtu)	1,526	1,554	1,554	1,555
Average LNG revenue (\$/MMBtu) (\$)	7.05	7.19	6.90	7.13
Average # of liquefaction trains online	6	6	6	6

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- Additional long-term LNG contracts with investment-grade counterparties
- Potential for additional project development

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies [here](#)

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- Additional expansion at the Sabine Pass site

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- Construction cost escalation could negatively affect project returns and create additional capital requirement
- Global liquefied natural gas markets no longer support North American exports

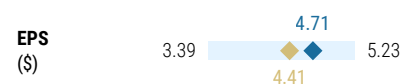
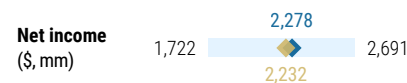
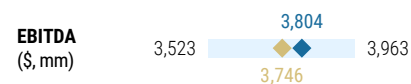
OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	93.4%	
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	1.7x	
HF Sector Net Exposure	4.7%	

Refinitiv, MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure - Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2027e



Mean Morgan Stanley Estimates
Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Important note regarding economic sanctions. This report references jurisdictions which may be the subject of economic sanctions. Readers are solely responsible for ensuring that their investment activities are carried out in compliance with applicable laws.

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Valuation Methodology and Risks

Excelerate Energy Inc (EE.N)

Model uses sum-of-the-parts-based DCF valuation of its FSRU operations with market risk premiums specific to countries in which the company operates. Assumes 40-year useful life of assets with 11% WACC.

Risks to Upside

- Negotiating contracts on growth projects and reaching FID
- Identification of growth projects beyond current pipeline
- Continued growth of global gas and LNG demand in key markets

Risks to Downside

- Potential LNG demand destruction from high commodity prices
- Securing gas supply for growth projects and downstream customers

Cheniere Energy Inc (LNG.N)

Valuation is based on a SOTP DCF valuation that includes a) cash flows from existing contracts on Cheniere's base platform including Stage 3, b) CCL Midscale Trains 8 & 9, c) more expansion at SPL and CCL, and d) long-term SPA contracts securing run-rate cash flows. We estimate the fair value of \$308/sh assuming a 7.5% blended cost of equity.

Risks to Upside

- High LNG prices improve CMI margins
- Increased contracting decreases commodity exposure
- Additional Trains reach FID

Risks to Downside

- Low LNG prices impact uncontracted volumes
- Failure to sign additional offtake contracts limits expansion potential
- Earlier commencement to debt repayments could limit free cash flow

NextDecade Corporation (NEXT.O)

Derived from our sum of the parts DCF, giving 100% value to a 3 Train facility with 20.8% ownership, Train 4 at 60% ownership, and Train 5 at 70% ownership.

Risks to Upside

- Higher LNG prices
- Company reaches FID sooner than anticipated
- Company could receive addition funding required to progress the project

Risks to Downside

- Company fails to reach FID
- Additional equity/debt financing could be required

Venture Global Inc (VG.N)

Valuation is based on a SOTP DCF that includes Venture Global's FID projects (Calcasieu Pass, Plaquemines, CP2 Phases 1 & 2) & near-FID bolt-ons at Plaquemines and CP2. We use a long-term price deck in 2030+ and assume \$10 JKM and \$3.75 HH. We estimate the fair value of \$22/sh assuming a 6.5% WACC on contracted capacity and 7.3% on uncontracted capacity.

Risks to Upside

- High LNG prices improve margins
- Increased contracting at higher prices reduces commodity exposure
- Additional projects reach FID

Risks to Downside

- Low LNG prices impact uncontracted volumes
- Failure to sign short-term contracts for uncommitted capacity creates downside risk
- EPC structures offer room for cost overruns

Risk Reward Reference links

1. View explanation of Options Probabilities methodology - [Options_Probabilities_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
2. View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes - [RR_Themes_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
3. View explanation of regional hierarchies - [GEG_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
4. View explanation of Theme/Exposure methodology - [ESG_Sustainable_Solutions_External_Link.pdf](#)
5. View explanation of HERS methodology - [ESG_HERS_External_Link.pdf](#)

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Within the last 12 months, Morgan Stanley has received compensation for investment banking services from Cheniere Energy Inc, Cheniere Energy Partners LP.

In the next 3 months, Morgan Stanley expects to receive or intends to seek compensation for investment banking services from Cheniere Energy Inc, Exceleerate Energy Inc, Venture Global Inc.

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Morgan Stanley & Co. LLC makes a market in the securities of Cheniere Energy Partners LP, Exceleerate Energy Inc.

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Global Stock Ratings Distribution

(as of June 30, 2026)

The Stock Ratings described below apply to Morgan Stanley's Fundamental Equity Research and do not apply to Debt Research produced by the Firm.

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1544	42%	453	49%	29%	757	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	390	42%	25%	769	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	544	15%	89	10%	16%	204	12%
Total	3,668		933			1731	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

Analyst Stock Ratings

Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Equal-weight (E). The stock's total return is expected to be in line with the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Not-Rated (NR). Currently the analyst does not have adequate conviction about the stock's total return relative to the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Underweight (U). The stock's total return is expected to be below the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

Analyst Industry Views

Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

In-Line (I): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be in line with the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Cautious (C): The analyst views the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months with caution vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Benchmarks for each region are as follows: North America - S&P 500; Latin America - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI Latin America Index; Europe - MSCI Europe; Japan - TOPIX; Asia - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

Cheniere Energy Inc (LNG.N) - As of 07/21/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Diversified Natural Gas



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : 0/I; 2/24/26 : E/C; 3/23/26 : 0/I

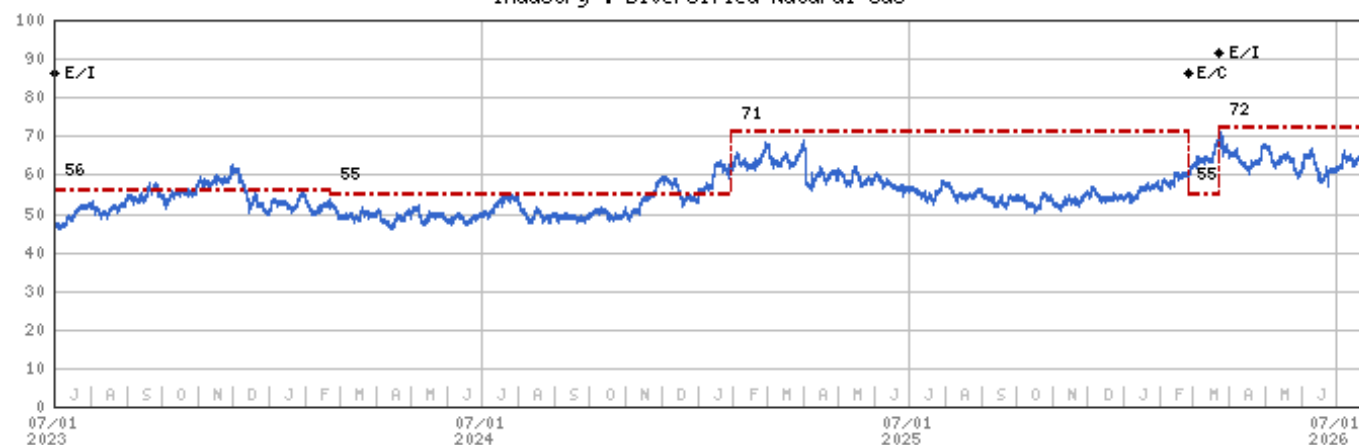
Price Target History: 6/7/21 : 94; 10/24/21 : 132; 2/25/22 : 140; 4/27/22 : 150; 5/5/22 : 153; 8/5/22 : 154; 9/14/22 : 203; 2/14/23 : 188; 2/23/23 : 189; 11/3/23 : 191; 10/31/24 : 195; 1/30/25 : 255; 8/7/25 : 258; 2/24/26 : 236; 3/23/26 : 313; 4/20/26 : 308

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Cheniere Energy Partners LP (CQP.N) - As of 07/21/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Diversified Natural Gas



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : E/I; 2/24/26 : E/C; 3/23/26 : E/I

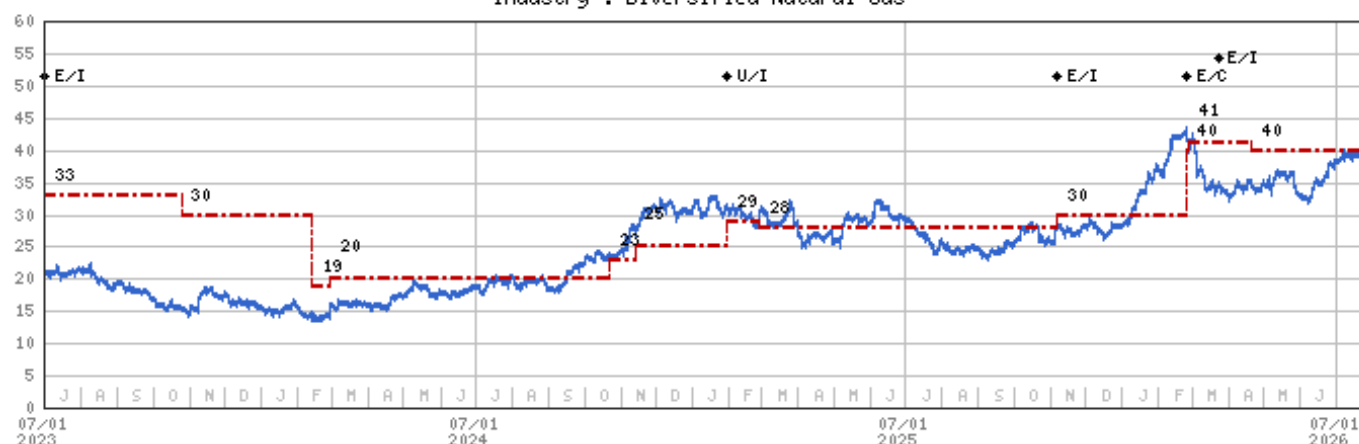
Price Target History: 6/7/21 : 43; 10/24/21 : 45; 4/27/22 : 48; 7/26/22 : 49; 8/5/22 : 48; 9/14/22 : 56; 2/22/24 : 55; 1/30/25 : 71; 2/24/26 : 55; 3/23/26 : 72

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Excelerate Energy Inc (EE.N) - As of 07/21/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Diversified Natural Gas



Stock Rating History: 5/9/22 : E/I; 1/30/25 : U/I; 11/6/25 : E/I; 2/24/26 : E/C; 3/23/26 : E/I

Price Target History: 5/9/22 : 31; 5/26/22 : 32; 10/25/22 : 33; 2/14/23 : 32; 4/5/23 : 33; 10/25/23 : 30; 2/13/24 : 19; 2/29/24 : 20; 10/22/24 : 23; 11/13/24 : 25; 1/30/25 : 29; 2/27/25 : 28; 11/6/25 : 30; 2/24/26 : 40; 2/26/26 : 41; 4/20/26 : 40

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format: MM/DD/YY Price Target: -- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

NextDecade Corporation (NEXT.O) - As of 07/21/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Diversified Natural Gas



Stock Rating History: 7/1/21 : O/I; 9/12/25 : E/I; 2/24/26 : E/C; 3/23/26 : E/I

Price Target History: 6/7/21 : 6; 2/15/22 : 5; 4/27/22 : 8; 10/25/22 : 10; 7/10/25 : 15; 9/12/25 : 10; 2/24/26 : 7; 4/20/26 : 8

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format: MM/DD/YY Price Target: -- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Venture Global Inc (VG.N) - As of 07/21/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Diversified Natural Gas



Stock Rating History: 2/24/26 : U/C; 3/23/26 : O/I

Price Target History: 2/24/26 : 8; 3/23/26 : 22; 4/20/26 : 20; 5/12/26 : 22

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)

Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —

Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View

Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)

Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

Effective January 13, 2014, the industry view benchmarks for Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific are as follows: relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Diversified Natural Gas

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (07/20/2026)
Devin McDermott		
Cheniere Energy Inc (LNG.N)	O (03/23/2026)	\$264.95
Cheniere Energy Partners LP (CQP.N)	E (09/20/2019)	\$63.83
Excelerate Energy Inc (EE.N)	E (11/06/2025)	\$38.91
NextDecade Corporation (NEXT.O)	E (09/12/2025)	\$7.68
Venture Global Inc (VG.N)	O (03/23/2026)	\$14.29

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.